

Screen Time and Sleep Among U.S. High School Students

2007 Youth Risk Behavior Survey (YRBS) | One-page statistical summary

Research Question

Is recreational computer / video game use associated with shorter sleep on average school nights?

Variables

Outcome: sleep hours (Q97)
Predictor: non-school computer/video game hours (Q82)
Controls: sex and grade

Cleaned Sample

n = 12,042
Grades 9-12
Missing selected variables removed

Methods

One-way ANOVA + OLS regression with HC3 robust standard errors. Categories were converted to approximate hours for interpretation.

ANOVA

F = 17.41

p = 3.6e-20
eta² = 0.009

Regression

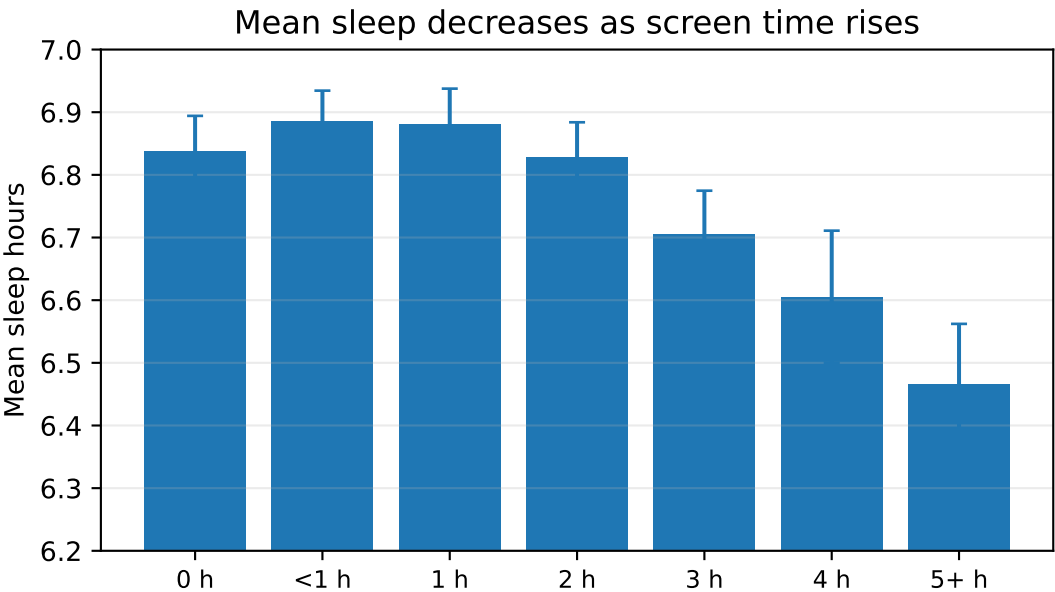
-5.6 min

per extra screen-time hour
robust p < .001

Practical Difference

-22 min

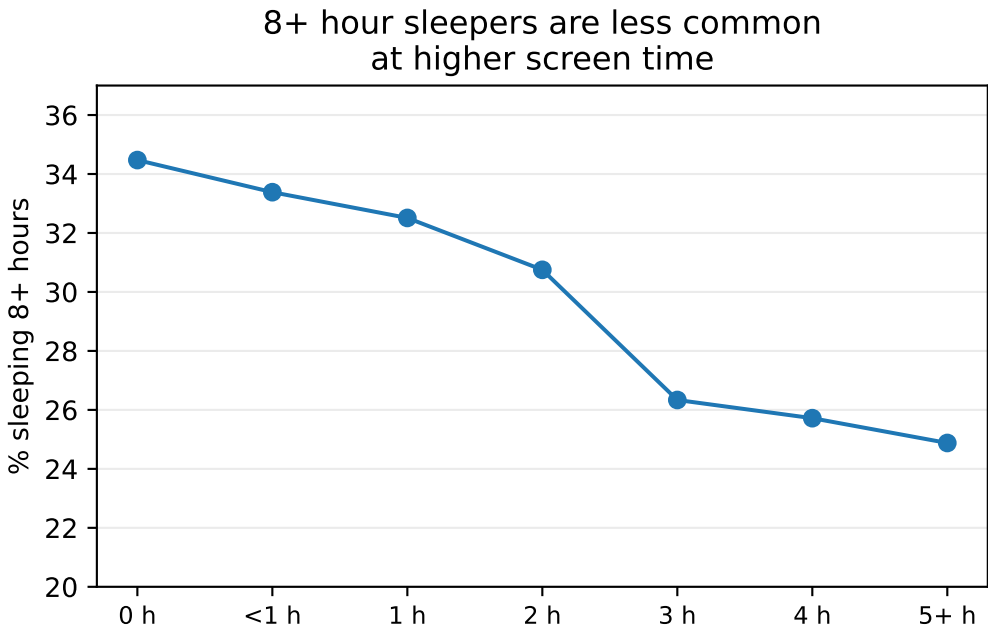
5+ h group vs 0 h group
mean sleep difference



Interpretation

Students reporting 5+ hours of recreational screen time slept about 22 fewer minutes than students reporting no screen time. The regression estimates about 5.6 fewer minutes of sleep for each additional screen-time hour after adjusting for sex and grade.

Limitation: This is a simplified unweighted class-project analysis, not an official CDC survey estimate.



Conclusion

Screen time is statistically associated with sleep duration, but the effect size is small. This supports a cautious conclusion: recreational screen use may relate to shorter sleep, yet other factors also matter.